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XCELerate 2026

Powering the Future of Mobility!

Case Study

E-Track

Engineering the Ideal Ride-Service Vehicle for India 2035







Background

India’s ride-service market is rapidly evolving, with mobility needs ranging from short intra-city trips and daily office commutes to airport transfers, inter-city travel and shared mobility services. Future operators may use BEV, HEV, PHEV, CNG, Bio-CNG and other technologies. The challenge is to identify the ideal ride-service vehicle that balances customer comfort, driver profitability, fleet efficiency and sustainability.

Problem Statement

Design the Ideal Ride-Service Vehicle for India 2035. Determine the optimal vehicle size, seating configuration, body style, powertrain strategy and digital ecosystem for intra-city, inter-city, shared and premium mobility services. The solution should maximize customer satisfaction, driver earnings, fleet profitability and scalability across India.

Deliverables

Prepare a detailed vehicle concept proposal that covers the following:

1. **Future Ride-Service Market Assessment:** size and segment India’s 2035 ride-service demand across intra-city, daily commute, airport, inter-city and shared/premium use cases, and identify where the volume and the margin will sit.
2. **Vehicle Concept Proposal:** recommend the vehicle’s size, seating configuration and body style, with a clear rationale for the segments you are targeting.
3. **Powertrain & Energy Strategy:** choose among BEV, HEV, PHEV, CNG, Bio-CNG or a mix, and justify it on cost, range, charging/refuelling readiness and sustainability for a high-utilisation fleet.
4. **Technical Specifications:** define the key specifications: range and energy, battery or fuel system, safety, durability for commercial duty cycles, comfort, and interior and luggage space.
5. **Total Cost of Ownership Analysis:** model the economics from the operator’s and driver’s point of view (purchase, energy, maintenance, uptime, residual value) and show how the vehicle improves driver earnings and fleet profitability.
6. **AI & Connected Mobility Ecosystem:** specify the digital layer: telematics, fleet and battery management, driver and rider apps, safety and predictive maintenance, and the data that connects them.
7. **Implementation Roadmap:** lay out a realistic path to scale across India, covering phasing, localisation and supply chain, infrastructure dependencies and partnerships.

What We’re Looking For

- **Systems thinking:** a coherent vehicle where size, powertrain, specifications and cost reinforce one another.
- **Evidence-based choices:** decisions backed by numbers on demand, energy and economics.
- **Operator & driver economics:** a credible TCO that genuinely improves earnings and fleet profitability.
- **Feasibility for India:** realistic on infrastructure, localisation and commercial duty cycles by 2035.
- **Digital depth:** a connected ecosystem that adds real operational value, not features for their own sake.
- **Clarity:** a simple, well-argued story, with numbers where they matter.

Round 1: Executive Summary

Submit a **2-slide presentation** of your proposed solution, in PDF format. Use the two slides to tell a tight, decision-ready story:

- **Slide 1:** The vehicle: your concept (size, seating, body style, powertrain) and the market logic behind it.
- **Slide 2:** The case: headline specifications, the TCO and driver-earnings story, the connectedmobility layer, and your roadmap to scale.

Eligibility

- Open to final-year students enrolled in B.E./B.Tech or Integrated Dual Degree programmes at select campuses.
- Refer to the **competition page** for the list of eligible campuses

Team Formation Guidelines

- Register with your official college email ID.
- Teams of 2–3 members, all from the same institute.
- Cross-specialisation teams are allowed; cross-year teams are not.
- Every member must give consent to participate; a student can be part of only one team.
- There is no limit on the number of teams per institute. Team members cannot be changed once registration closes.

The Core Challenge

What should be the Ideal Ride-Service Vehicle for India 2035 that can efficiently serve both intra-city and inter-city mobility needs while maximizing passenger comfort, driver income and fleet profitability?